- **Scenario**:
    - This solo tabletop tests the suspicious PowerShell response playbook using findings from the previous Wireshark lab. A Windows computer received suspicious scripts and repeatedly contacted 5.252.153.241. Execution remains unconfirmed. Additional developments introduced during this exercise are fictional, and all response actions are simulated.
- **Participants/Roles:**
    - Justin Rodriguez is the sole participant, simulating the SOC analyst, incident lead, IT administrator, and business owner. Decisions will be recorded from each role's perspective. (no real systems will be changed.)
- **Exercise timeline:**
    - *T+0/Initial alert:* Network evidence shows suspicious script delivery and repeated requests from DESKTOP-L8C5GSJ to 5.252.153.241. Endpoint logs have not been reviewed yet.
    - *T+10/Business pressure (fictional):* The business owner linked to this response says the employee urgently needs the isolated computer to finish important work. Endpoint analysis is still incomplete.
    - *T+20/New evidence (fictional):* Endpoint logs confirm that the suspicious PowerShell script ran. A scheduled task launches it whenever the user signs in.
    - *T+40/Recovery request(fictional):* IT reports that the computer was rebuilt from a trusted image. Updates and security tools are installed, and initial checks show no suspicious activity.
- **Decisions and actions**
    - *T+0/Containment decision:* I would have the incident lead authorize network isolation to limit potential harm. Suspicious script delivery provides enough evidence for precautionary containment, even though execution remains unconfirmed. Keep the computer powered on and preserve available evidence.
    - *T+10/Business continuity decision:* Keep the affected computer isolated and provide a clean replacement device so the employee can continue working. Reconnecting before the investigation is complete could expose other systems to harm.
    - *T+20/Eradication decision:* After preserving evidence, remove the malicious script and scheduled task while keeping the computer isolated. Blocking the server alone leaves persistence in place, allowing the script to run again. Rebuild from a trusted image if the computer's integrity cannot be established.
    - *T+40/Recovery decision*: Verify that the rebuild image came from an approved internal source, security tools and logging work, and essential applications pass testing. Obtain approval from the incident lead and business owner before reconnecting, then monitor for recurring suspicious activity.

- **Gaps identified:**
    - The playbook does not specify how quickly isolation should occur or who approves it if the incident lead is unavailable.
    - It does not define how long to monitor the computer after recovery.
    - It does not specify how to provide a clean replacement device during isolation.
- **Improvements**:
    - *Incident lead:* Define isolation timing and a backup approver.
    - *SOC analyst:* Set a recovery monitoring period and escalation criteria.
    - *IT administrator:* Document how to provide a clean replacement device.
    - *Target*: Complete these updates before the next tabletop.